



STERN-HALMA

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

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2–6
PLAYERS

20–45
min
MINUTES

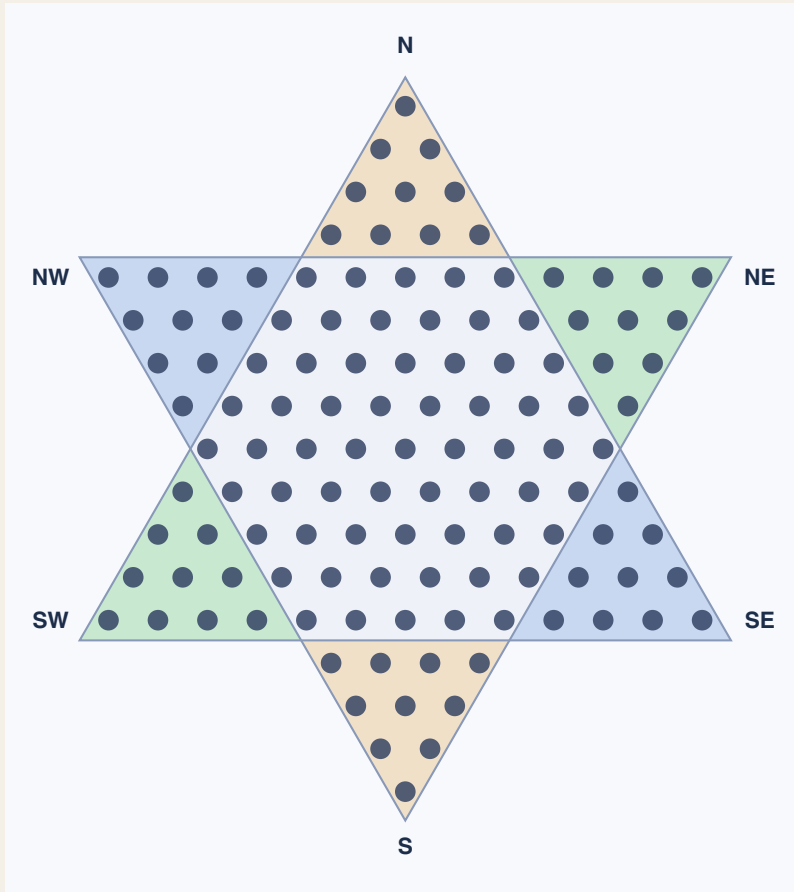
8+
AGE

Published by Moddable Games · v0.1.0 · Printed 23 June 2026

OVERVIEW

Stern-Halma originated in Germany in 1892 as a variation of the older American game Halma. It supports two to six players and is played on a six-pointed star board.

THE BOARD



Stern-Halma — six-pointed star board, 121 holes

The board is in the shape of a six-pointed star formed by two overlapping equilateral triangles. It contains 121 holes:

- ♦ **6 triangular arms**, each with 10 holes arranged in four rows of 4, 3, 2, 1 holes (outermost to innermost)
- ♦ **Central hexagonal play area** with 61 holes; the interior of a hexagon with each side five holes long

The six triangular arms point to the six compass directions: N, NE, SE, S, SW, NW. Each arm serves as a starting camp for one player in a 6-player game.

SETUP

Pieces: Each player has 10 pieces in a distinct colour, filling one triangular arm.

Camp assignment by player count:

PLAYERS	ARMS USED	ARRANGEMENT
2	N and S	Opposite arms
3	N, SE, and SW	Alternating arms
4	NE, SE, SW, and NW	Alternating pairs
6	All six arms	One arm each

Note: 5-player is not a valid configuration, as each player must have a diagonally opposite arm as their goal and a five-armed arrangement has no such pairing.

First move: Decide by mutual agreement or lot; play proceeds clockwise.

MOVEMENT

On each turn a player moves one marble. A marble may:

- ♦ **Step:** Move to any adjacent hole, provided it is empty. A marble may step in any of the six directions of the triangular grid.
- ♦ **Hop:** Jump over any adjacent marble (own or opponent) to the empty hole immediately beyond in the same straight line.
- ♦ **Chain hop:** After a hop, the same marble may continue hopping over further marbles in any direction (direction may change between hops). A player may stop a chain at any point.

Hops are never forced. A player may step instead of hop even if a hop is available.

Jumped marbles are never removed from the board.

WINNING

The first player to move all 10 of their marbles into the triangular arm diagonally opposite their starting arm wins.

CAMP RULE

Once a marble enters the destination arm, it is strongly recommended that it remain there. The treatment of marbles that have reached the goal (whether they may be moved back out to assist chain hops) is left to player agreement before the game begins. The traditional rule is that a marble in the destination arm should not be voluntarily moved out.

ATTRIBUTION

Stern-Halma. Originated in Germany, 1892. Public domain. Rules confirmed from [ezekeal/bgg-get](#) (BGG entry for Sternhalma) and [Lehi-Innovation/boardgame-rules](#) (independent jump-rule audit confirming chain hops, no forced jump, no capture). Board dimensions (121 holes, 6 × 10-hole arms, 61-hole centre) confirmed from [mastersofgames.com](#) and Wikipedia.



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